

Every technique in this week's lab — hijacking local resolution, spoofing a DNS response, and poisoning a server's cache — has a real, well-documented counterpart that has redirected real users and stolen real money. This sheet maps each lab task to its live-fire equivalent.

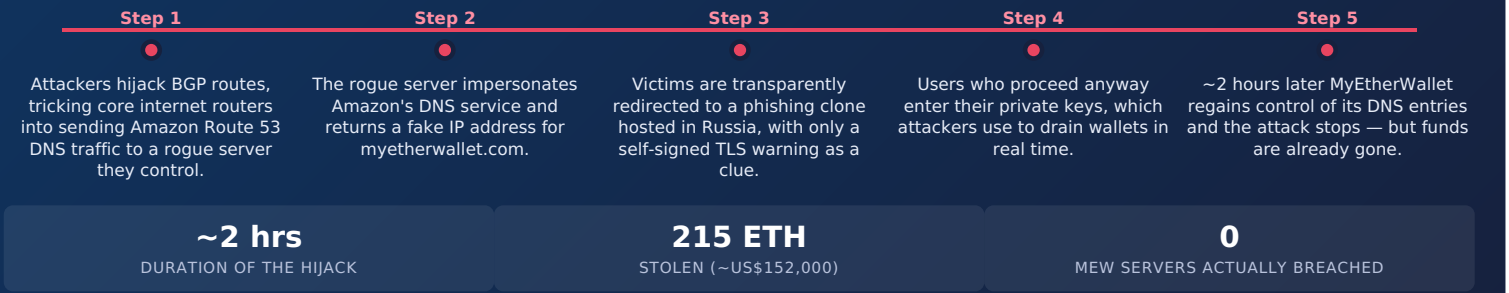
Lab Task → Real-World Equivalent

TASK 1 Modifying the HOSTS file	→	DNSChanger Malware (2007-2011) Malware silently rewrote infected machines' DNS server settings — the same effect as your lab's edit to <i>/etc/network/interfaces</i>, just delivered remotely and covertly. Millions of machines worldwide were redirected to attacker-controlled resolvers for ad fraud and further phishing, until the FBI's "Operation Ghost Click" took it down.
TASK 2 Spoofing a DNS response on the LAN	→	Local Wi-Fi / LAN Pharming (widely used in banking phishing) Attackers on the same network as a victim (compromised routers, rogue Wi-Fi access points, or ARP-spoofed LANs) sniff outgoing DNS queries and race the legitimate server with a forged reply — exactly the criteria your Netwox/Netwag exercise walks through. Widely reported against home-router users in Brazil and elsewhere to redirect online banking traffic to lookalike sites.
TASK 3 DNS Server Cache Poisoning	→	The Kaminsky Bug (2008) Dan Kaminsky discovered that predictable DNS transaction IDs and source ports made cache poisoning far easier than anyone realised — poison the resolver once, and every subsequent user of that server gets the spoofed answer. It triggered a coordinated, multi-vendor emergency patch across nearly every DNS implementation on the internet.

HEADLINE CASE STUDY

The MyEtherWallet DNS Hijack — 24 April 2018

The clearest large-scale illustration of "poison the infrastructure, not the victim" — the same principle behind Task 3. Attackers never touched MyEtherWallet's servers; they attacked the DNS path itself.



Related Incidents Worth Mentioning

JAN 2018 BlackWallet DNS Hijack Attackers hijacked BlackWallet.com's DNS entries via a compromised Amazon Route 53 setup, stealing over US\$400,000 in Stellar Lumens (XLM) from users who were redirected without any visible warning.	2011-12 Brazilian Home-Router Pharming Widespread campaigns reconfigured consumer routers' DNS settings (often via default-password exploits), silently redirecting online banking customers to convincing phishing clones for months at a time.
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